



Blender keyboard shortcuts and viewport navigation

X Y Z

3D Navigation via Gizmo



Click or drag the gizmo

Axis label: jump to that orthographic view.

Matching empty circle: jump to the opposite view.

Hover near the gizmo to reveal a circle; drag inside it to orbit.



Use the four tool icons

Magnifying glass: drag up/down to zoom.

Hand: drag to pan up, down, left, or right.

Camera: toggle camera view.

Grid: toggle orthographic / perspective.

3D Navigation via Number Pad

NAVIGATING WITH THE KEYBOARD'S NUMBER PAD



Numberpad corner keys jump to fixed views or their opposite. The even numbers orbit the view in that cardinal direction.

+ zooms in.

- zooms out.

NAVIGATING WITH THE MIDDLE MOUSE BUTTON

Orbit Drag with the **middle mouse button** to rotate the camera around your scene.

Pan Hold **Shift** and drag with the middle mouse button to slide the view.

Tip: If you lose your object, select it in the Outliner, click back in the viewport for focus, and press **.** on the numberpad to bring it back into view.

Simple workflow

REPEAT THIS LOOP

1. Select your target (objects in **Layout**; vertex/edge/face when **Modeling**).
Use **Shift** to add to existing selection.
2. Start operation: **G**rab, **R**otate, or **S**cale
3. **Optional:** Constrain **X**, **Y**, or **Z** axis
4. Move mouse (no mouse button) for amount and direction, using **Shift** for precision or **Ctrl** for increments, or type a numeric value.
5. **Enter** to commit, or **ESC** to cancel & revert

Transforming selected object, vertex, edge, or face

Changes to position, orientation, or size are called transforms.

G

Grab (or "move", "translate")

Press **G** to grab.

Optionally add **X**, **Y**, or **Z** to constrain to an axis.

Example: Tap **G** then **X** to move along X

Hold **Shift** makes smaller movements.

R

Rotate

Press **R** to rotate.

Optionally add **X**, **Y**, or **Z** to select axis of rotation.

Example: Tap **R** then **X** to rotate around X

Hit **R** twice to rotate freely.

S

Scale

Press **S** to make the object larger or smaller.

Optionally add **X**, **Y**, or **Z** to stretch on one axis.

Example: Tap **S** then **X** to stretch along X

Finish or undo: **Enter** commits the operation. **Esc** backs out and reverts the change.

Undo or adjust

CORRECTING MISTAKES

Ctrl + **Z**

Undo last action.

Shift + **Ctrl** + **Z**

Redo last undo.

F9

Adjust last operation

Viewport controls

PANELS + TOOLS

N

Sidebar on/off — the right-side panel for details about the selection.

T

Toolbar on/off — the tool shelf on the left side of the viewport.

Shift + **A**

Add an object — opens the Add menu.

Modeling mode

TOP-ROW NUMBERS

In **Edit Mode**, the top-row number keys choose what part of a mesh you select:

1

Points / vertices

2

Edges

3

Faces

Easy to mix up: numberpad **1** is a front view; top-row **1** is vertex selection in Edit Mode.

Remember: **red = X**, **green = Y**, **blue = Z**. Note these colors on the gizmo axis labels, transform handles, and axis lines in the viewport.

Learn More

Blender Manual

docs.blender.org/manual/en/5.2/

Animated Cheatsheet and Commands

hollisbrown.github.io/blendershortcuts/

Blender Guru

youtube.com/@blenderguru

Complete 2026 tutorial: youtu.be/z-XI9tGqH14